

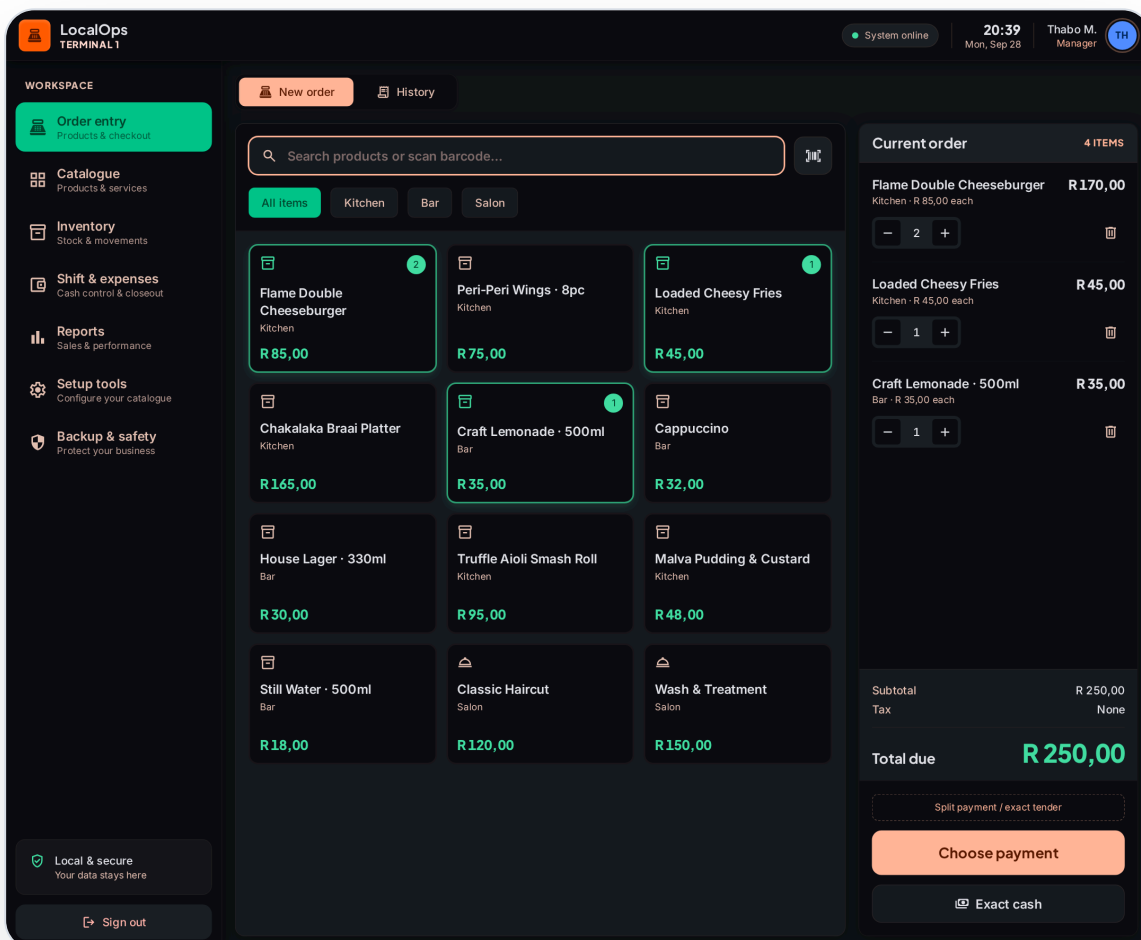


LOCALOPS POS • VERSION 0.1.0

Offline - first point of sale

User manual for tellers and trainers

Everything you do on the till, shown with a picture of every screen. Written in plain English. Follow the steps in order and you cannot go wrong.



Who it is for

Tellers, supervisors, trainers, owners

Money

South African rand (R)

Internet

Not needed — everything is on this computer

Edition

1.0 · September 2026

1. How to use this manual

This manual shows every screen in LocalOps POS. Each picture is a real screenshot of the program. The example shop is called **Moko's Lifestyle Centre**. Your shop name, your items and your prices will be different, but every button sits in the same place.

The three ways to read it

IF YOU ARE...	READ THIS
A new teller	Chapters 3 to 9, then the Quick reference card at the back. That is everything you need for a normal shift.
A trainer	Chapter 19. It contains a 45 - minute lesson plan, practice exercises and a sign - off checklist.
An owner or manager	All of it, especially chapters 12 to 17 (catalogue, stock, money and backups).

Signs used in this manual

TIP

A faster or easier way to do the same thing.

GOOD HABIT

Something that keeps your till and your money correct.

CAREFUL

Something that is easy to get wrong. Read it twice.

NEVER DO THIS

An action that can cost the business money or break trust.

Words we use

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
Till / terminal	This computer. Every sale is recorded against it.
Shift	One period of selling on this till, from the moment you count the opening cash to the moment you count the closing cash.
Order (cart)	The list of items the customer is buying right now, on the right-hand side of the sale screen.
Receipt	The record of a finished sale. It has a number, for example <code>PREVIEW-0001</code> .
Refund	Giving money back for part of a sale.
Void	Reversing a whole sale.
Department	A part of the business that sells, such as Kitchen, Bar or Salon.
Catalogue	The list of everything the business can sell.
Stock / inventory	How much of each product you physically have.
Variance	The difference between the cash the system expected and the cash you counted.

Contents

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1 How to use this manual | 12 Catalogue — products & services |
| 2 What LocalOps POS does | 13 Setup tools — categories, units, recipes |
| 3 Signing in | 14 Inventory — stock control |
| 4 The parts of the screen | 15 Shifts & expenses |
| 5 Opening the till | 16 Reports |
| 6 The sale screen | 17 Backup & safety |
| 7 Making a sale, step by step | 18 When something goes wrong |
| 8 Taking payment | 19 Trainer's guide |
| 9 The receipt | 20 Daily checklists |
| 10 Refunds and voids | 21 Quick reference card |
| 11 First-run setup (new business) | |

2. What LocalOps POS does

LocalOps POS is a till program that runs on one Windows computer. It works without the internet. All the information lives in a database file on that same computer.

It can

- ring up sales for products and services;
- take cash, card, EFT or “other” payments, including split payments;
- print the receipt of the sale you have just finished;
- record refunds and full voids without deleting anything;
- track how much stock you have, and reduce it automatically when you sell;
- open and close cash shifts and show you the variance;
- record business expenses paid out of the drawer;
- show sales, profit, payment and stock reports, and export them as a CSV file; and
- make verified backups of the database and restore them.

Four rules that never change

RULE	WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU
Nothing is ever deleted	A mistake is corrected by a refund or a void, and both the mistake and the correction stay in the history. This protects honest staff.
The money must balance	The Pay button stays switched off until the amounts you enter add up exactly to the total.
A shift must be open	No shift, no sales. Opening the shift is how the system knows how much cash was in the drawer when you started.
The data stays here	There is no cloud. If this computer is lost and there is no backup, the business history is lost. Make backups.

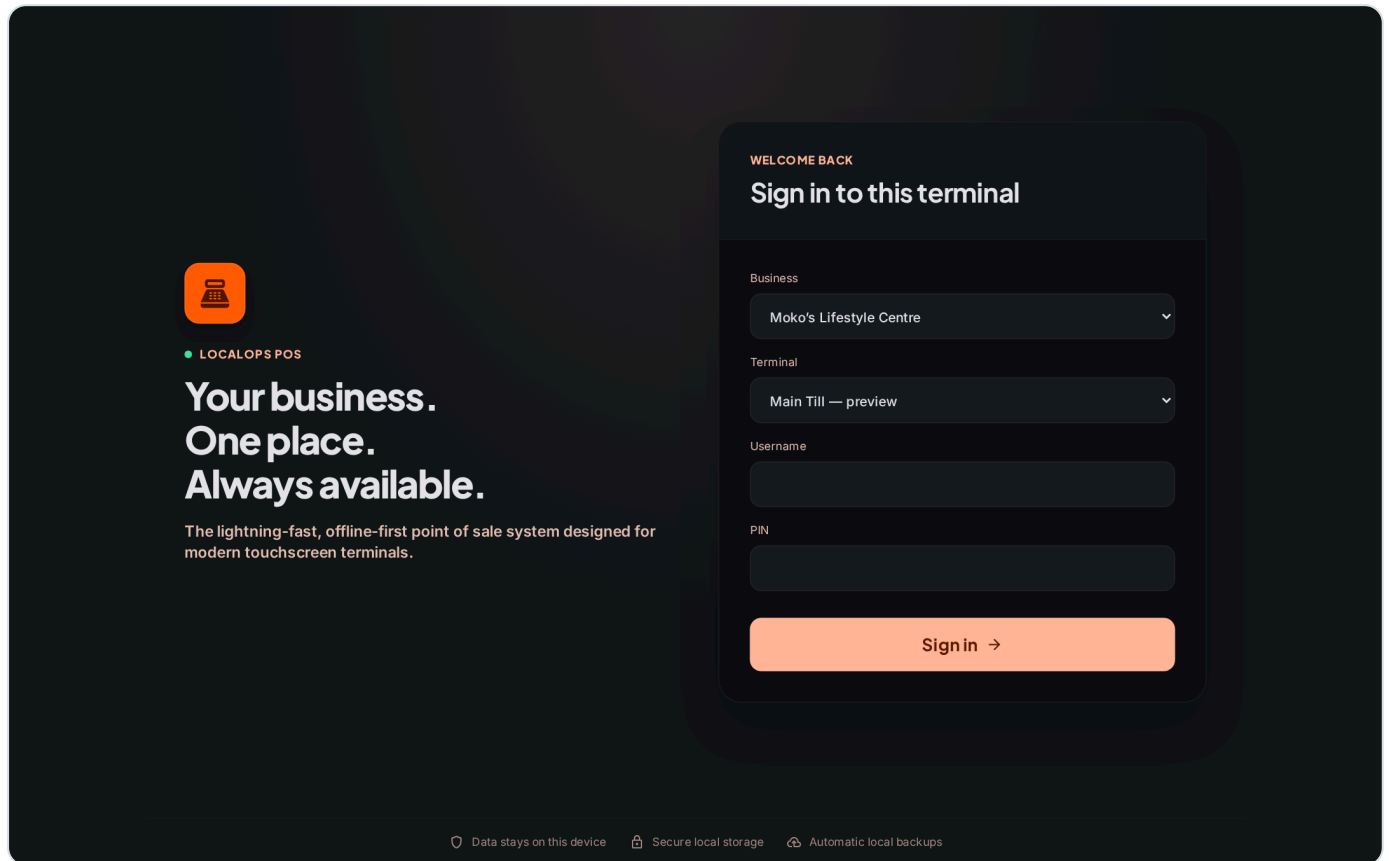
What this version cannot do

Do not promise a customer any of the following, because the screens do not exist yet:

- customer accounts, credit sales, lay-by or quotations;
- adding or editing staff accounts from inside the program (ask your administrator);
- editing or deleting a product after it has been created;
- re-printing an old receipt (print it at the moment of the sale);
- selling by pack or crate at the till — the till sells whole catalogue items; and
- sending backups to a USB drive or cloud from inside the program.

3. Signing in

When you start LocalOps POS on a computer that already has a business, you see the sign-in screen. Nothing can be done until you sign in with your own name and PIN.



Picture 3.1 — Sign in to this terminal. Business and Terminal are usually already correct. Type your username, then your PIN, then press **Sign in**.

- 1 Check **Business**. It must be your shop's name.
- 2 Check **Terminal**. It must be the till you are standing at, for example *Main Till*.
- 3 Type your **Username** in lower case, exactly as it was given to you.
- 4 Type your **PIN**. It is 4 to 12 numbers. The screen shows dots, not the numbers.
- 5 Press **Sign in**. The workspace opens.

NEVER DO THIS

Never use another person's username and PIN, and never tell anyone yours — not even a manager. Every sale, refund and expense is recorded under the name that is signed in. If you share your PIN, you are responsible for what someone else does with it.

CAREFUL

After **five wrong PINs** the account is locked for **five minutes**. Wait; do not keep trying. Also check that you picked the right business and terminal before you blame the PIN.

Signing out

Sign out is the last button at the bottom of the left-hand menu. Press it every single time you walk away from the till, even for a minute. If the till is left alone for five minutes without activity, the session ends by itself and you must sign in again.

TIP

Signing out does **not** close the shift and does not lose any sale. A finished sale is saved the moment you press Pay.

4. The parts of the screen

Every screen in LocalOps POS is built the same way: a strip at the top, a menu on the left, and the work area in the middle. Learn these three parts and you can find anything.

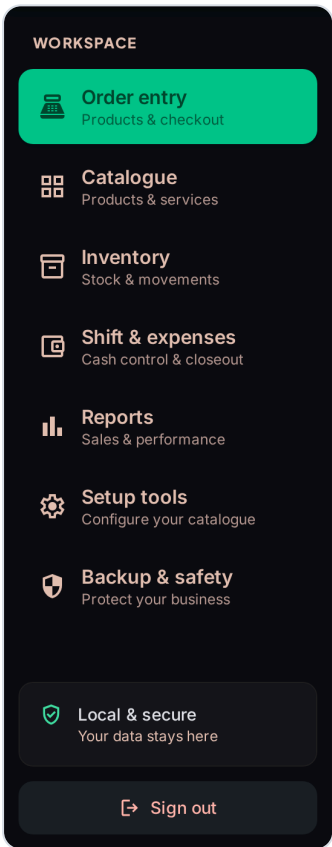
4.1 The top strip



Picture 4.1 — The top strip. Left: the program name and which till you are on (*TERMINAL 1*). Right: the **System online** badge, the time and date, and the name of the person signed in with their role.

Use the top strip to answer three questions in one glance: *Am I on the right till? What is the time? Who is signed in?* If the name is not yours, sign out and sign in again before you sell anything.

4.2 The left-hand menu



MENU ITEM	WHAT YOU DO THERE
Order entry	Sell, take payment, print the receipt, refund or void.
Catalogue	Add products and services and see the item list.
Inventory	Stock on hand, receive stock, transfers, waste, counts.
Shift & expenses	Open and close the till, record expenses.
Reports	Sales, profit, payments, stock value, CSV export.
Setup tools	Categories, units, packaging, recipes, which department sells what.
Backup & safety	Health checks, make a backup, restore a backup.

A teller normally only uses **Order entry** and **Shift & expenses**. The other pages may open but refuse an action with a “Permission denied” message if your account is not allowed to do it. That is normal, not a fault.

Picture 4.2 — The workspace menu. The green block shows where you are.

4.3 Messages

The program talks to you with one wide bar above the work area:

- Green** — it worked. Example: “Sale *PREVIEW-0001* completed. Receipt ready.”

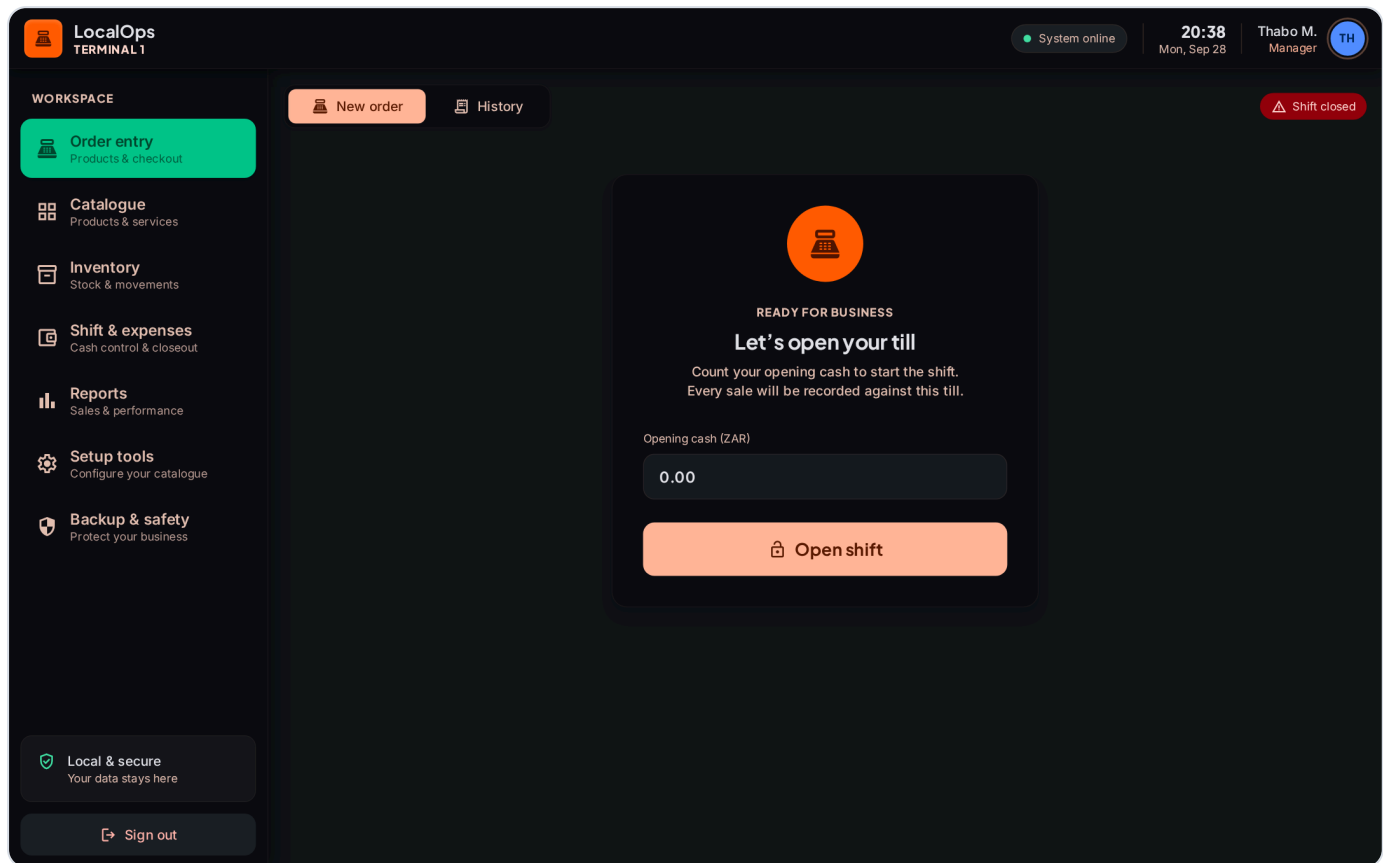
- **Red** — it did not work, and the bar says why. Example: *"Preview: insufficient stock. Sale was not completed."*

CAREFUL

When you see a red bar, **read it and fix the cause**. Do not press the button again and again — you may create the same transaction twice once the cause disappears.

5. Opening the till

A shift is the container for all the cash movement on this till. Until it is open, the sale screen shows a red **Shift closed** badge and nothing can be sold.



Picture 5.1 — “Let’s open your till”. This is what Order entry looks like before a shift is open. Count the drawer, type the amount, press **Open shift**.

- 1 Count the money that is physically in the drawer. Count it twice.
- 2 Type the amount in **Opening cash (ZAR)**. Use a full stop for cents: `500.00` , not `500,00` .
- 3 Press **Open shift**. The badge at the top right turns green (**Open shift**) and the products appear.

GOOD HABIT

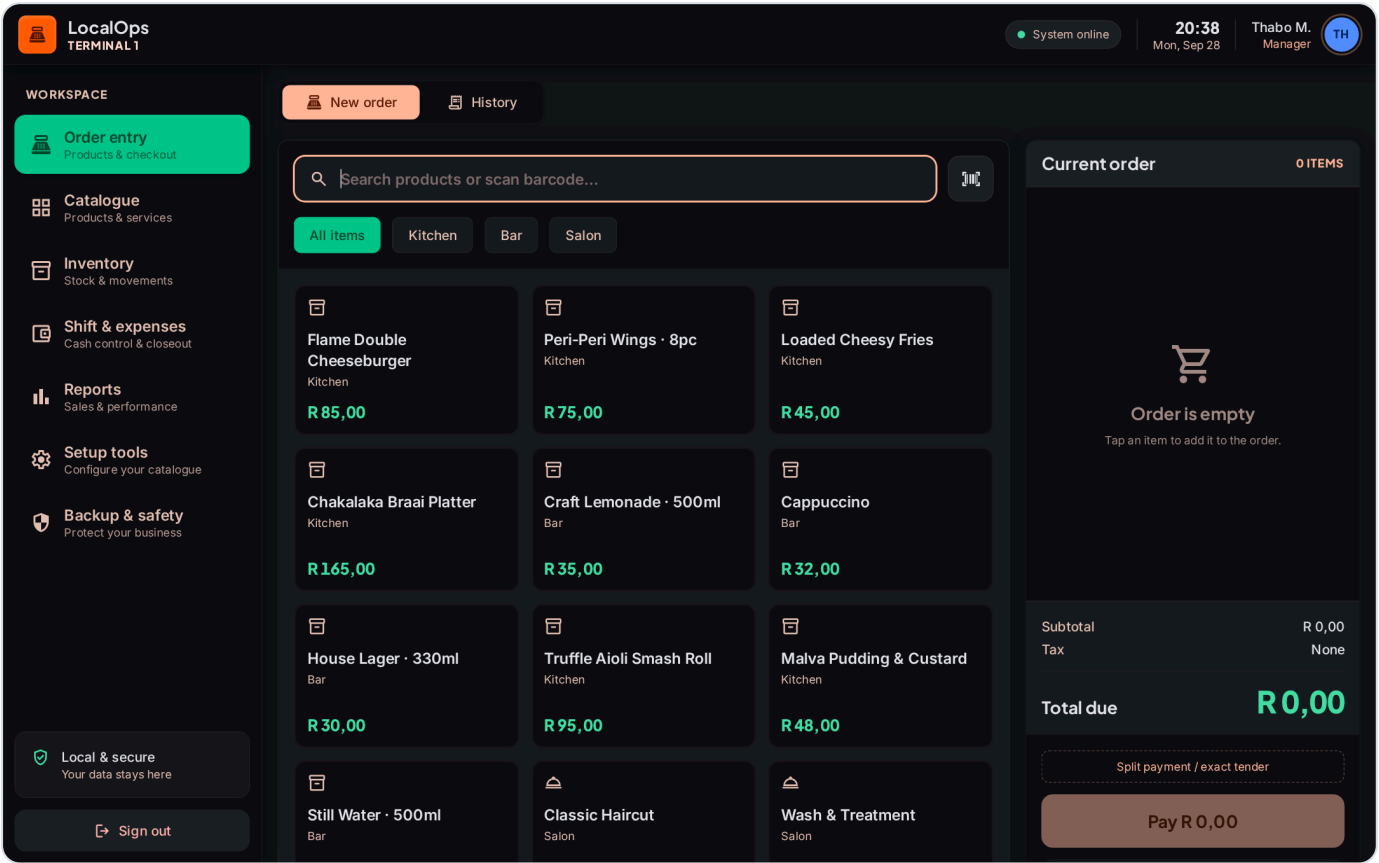
Enter the **true** counted amount, even if it is not the float you expected. If you enter a wrong opening amount, every cash figure for the whole shift will be wrong, and the variance at the end will blame the wrong person.

TIP

You can also open the shift from **Shift & expenses**. It is the same shift. One till can have only one shift open at a time.

6. The sale screen

This is where you will spend almost all of your time. It has two tabs at the top: **New order** (sell) and **History** (past sales, refunds and voids).



Picture 6.1 — New order, nothing added yet. Search bar on top, department tabs under it, item buttons in the middle, and the customer’s order on the right.

PART OF THE SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR
Search products or scan barcode...	Type part of a name to filter the buttons, or scan a barcode to add the item straight away.
Barcode icon (right of the search bar)	Puts the cursor back in the search bar, ready for the scanner.
All items / Kitchen / Bar / Salon	Department filter. "All items" shows everything. Your department names will differ.
Item buttons	One button per item, showing its name, department and price. A green number in the corner shows how many are already in the order.
Current order (right)	The customer's basket, with a line for every item, the subtotal, the tax and the Total due .
Split payment / exact tender	Opens the payment boxes so you can type amounts per method.
Choose payment / Pay R...	The big button that finishes the sale. It only works when the money balances.
Exact cash	One press fills in the exact cash amount for the whole total.

TIP

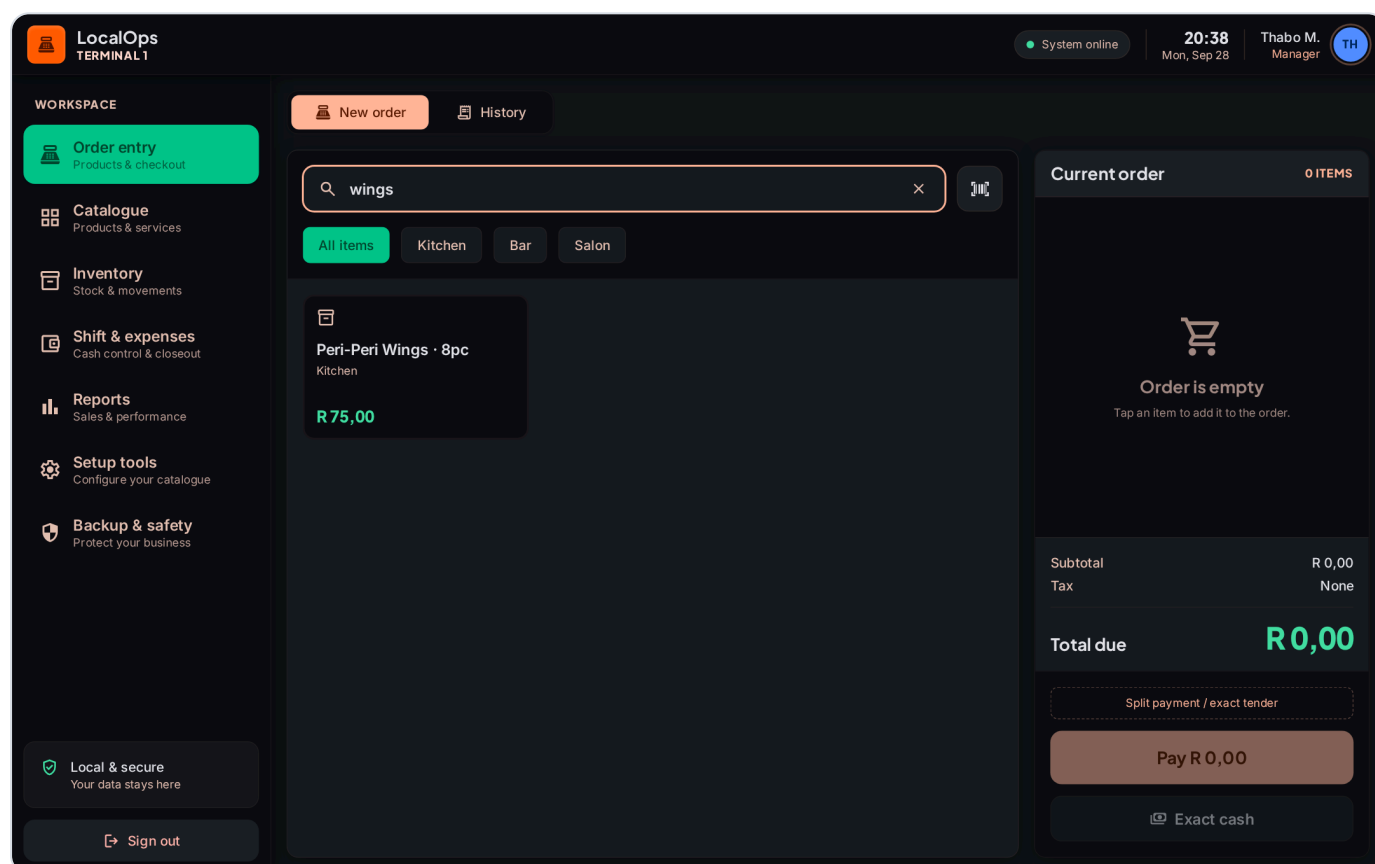
The little icon on each item button tells you what it is: a box for a **product** (something you hold in your hand, stock is reduced) and a serving dome for a **service** (work you do, such as a haircut).

7. Making a sale, step by step

7.1 Add the items

There are three ways to add an item. Use whichever is fastest:

WAY	HOW
Tap the button	Press the item on the grid. Press it again for a second one.
Scan the barcode	Point the scanner at the barcode. The item is added by itself. (The scanner types the number and presses Enter for you.)
Type and press Enter	Type the barcode, SKU or product code in the search bar and press Enter .



Picture 7.1 — Searching. Typing leaves only the matching items on the grid. Clear the box to see everything again.

CAREFUL

Typing a name and pressing Enter does **not** add an item. Enter only works on an exact barcode, SKU or product code. If nothing matches you see the red message *"No local item matches ..."*. When that happens, clear the box and tap the item button instead.

7.2 Check the order

The screenshot displays the LocalOps POS interface. The top header shows 'LocalOps TERMINAL 1', 'System online', the time '20:39' on 'Mon, Sep 28', and the user 'Thabo M. Manager'. The left sidebar lists workspace functions: Order entry (highlighted), Catalogue, Inventory, Shift & expenses, Reports, Setup tools, and Backup & safety. The main area features a 'New order' button and a search bar. Below the search bar are filters for 'All items', 'Kitchen', 'Bar', and 'Salon'. A grid of product cards is shown, each with an icon, name, department, and price. Some cards have green badges indicating quantities. The right panel, titled 'Current order' (4 ITEMS), lists the selected items with their individual prices and line totals. At the bottom of this panel, it shows a subtotal of R 250,00, no tax, and a total due of R 250,00. Payment options include 'Split payment / exact tender', 'Choose payment', and 'Exact cash'.

Item	Department	Price of one	Line total
Flame Double Cheeseburger	Kitchen	R 85,00	R 170,00
Loaded Cheesy Fries	Kitchen	R 45,00	R 45,00
Craft Lemonade · 500ml	Bar	R 35,00	R 35,00
Cappuccino	Bar	R 32,00	R 32,00
Chakalaka Braai Platter	Kitchen	R 165,00	R 165,00
House Lager · 330ml	Bar	R 30,00	R 30,00
Truffle Aioli Smash Roll	Kitchen	R 95,00	R 95,00
Malva Pudding & Custard	Kitchen	R 48,00	R 48,00
Still Water · 500ml	Bar	R 18,00	R 18,00
Classic Haircut	Salon	R 120,00	R 120,00
Wash & Treatment	Salon	R 150,00	R 150,00

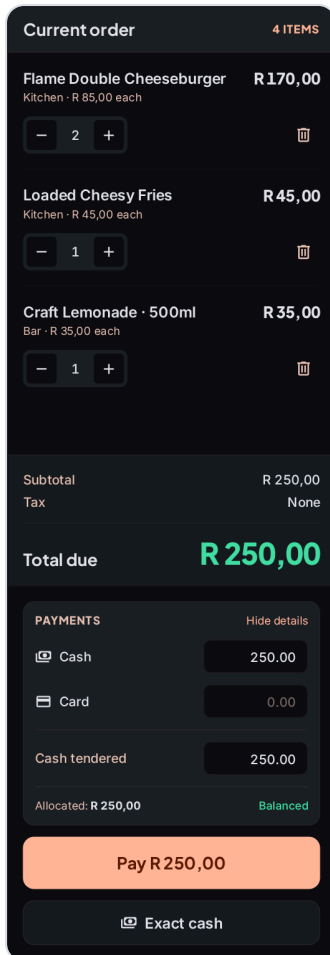
Current order summary:

Item	Department	Price of one	Line total
Flame Double Cheeseburger	Kitchen	R 85,00 each	R 170,00
Loaded Cheesy Fries	Kitchen	R 45,00 each	R 45,00
Craft Lemonade · 500ml	Bar	R 35,00 each	R 35,00
Cappuccino	Bar	R 32,00	R 32,00

Subtotal: R 250,00
Tax: None
Total due: R 250,00

Payment options: Split payment / exact tender, Choose payment, Exact cash

Picture 7.2 — Four items in the order. Each line shows the item, the department, the price of one, and the line total. The green badges on the item buttons show the same quantities.



Fixing a line

- **–** takes one off the line.
- **+** adds one more.
- Pressing **–** on a line with 1 removes the line.
- The **bin** icon on the right removes the whole line at once.

Reading the totals

- **Subtotal** — all the lines added up.
- **Tax** — shows *None* if the business does not charge tax in the system.
- **Total due** — the amount the customer must pay. Always read this number out loud to the customer.

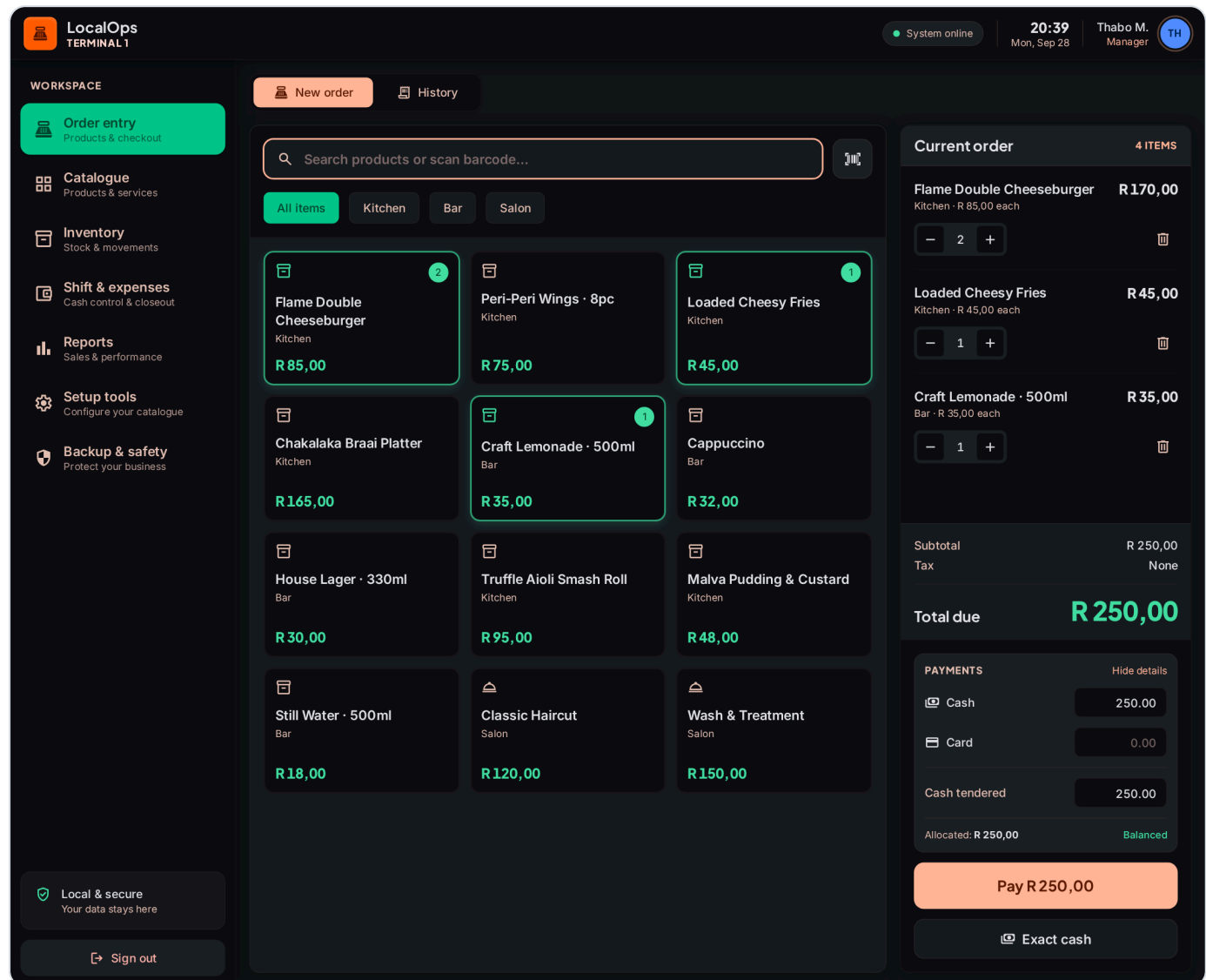
Picture 7.3 — The order panel, close up.

GOOD HABIT

Before you say the price, look at the order panel and check the **number of items** at the top right of the panel against what is on the counter. Most mistakes are a double tap, not a wrong price.

8. Taking payment

The rule is simple: **what you type must add up to the Total due**. When it does, the panel says **Balanced** and the big button turns on.



Picture 8.1 — Payment open. Press **Split payment / exact tender** (or **Choose payment**) to show the boxes for Cash and Card. Here the customer is paying R 250,00 in cash.

8.1 Cash, the fast way

- 1 Press **Exact cash**. The cash box and the **Cash tendered** box are both filled with the total.
- 2 If the customer hands you more money than the total, change **Cash tendered** to the amount they actually gave you, for example 300.00.
- 3 Check that the panel says **Balanced**.
- 4 Press **Pay R**
- 5 Give the change that the receipt shows. Count it into the customer's hand.

8.2 Card, EFT or other

- 1 Complete the payment on the card machine first and make sure it is approved.
- 2 Type the exact total in the box next to **Card** (or EFT / Other).
- 3 Leave **Cash** on 0.00 .
- 4 Check **Balanced** , then press **Pay R**

CAREFUL

You may not enter more than the total on a card, EFT or other line. Only cash may be over the amount, because only cash gives change.

8.3 Split payment (part cash, part card)

- 1 Press **Split payment / exact tender** to open the boxes.
- 2 Type the card part next to **Card**, for example 200.00 .
- 3 Type the cash part next to **Cash**, for example 50.00 .
- 4 Type what the customer physically gave you in **Cash tendered**, for example 100.00 .
- 5 The line under the boxes must read **Allocated: R 250,00** and **Balanced** . If it says *R ... remaining*, the amounts are short; if the button stays off, they are over.
- 6 Press **Pay R ...** and give the change.

8.4 Why the Pay button is grey

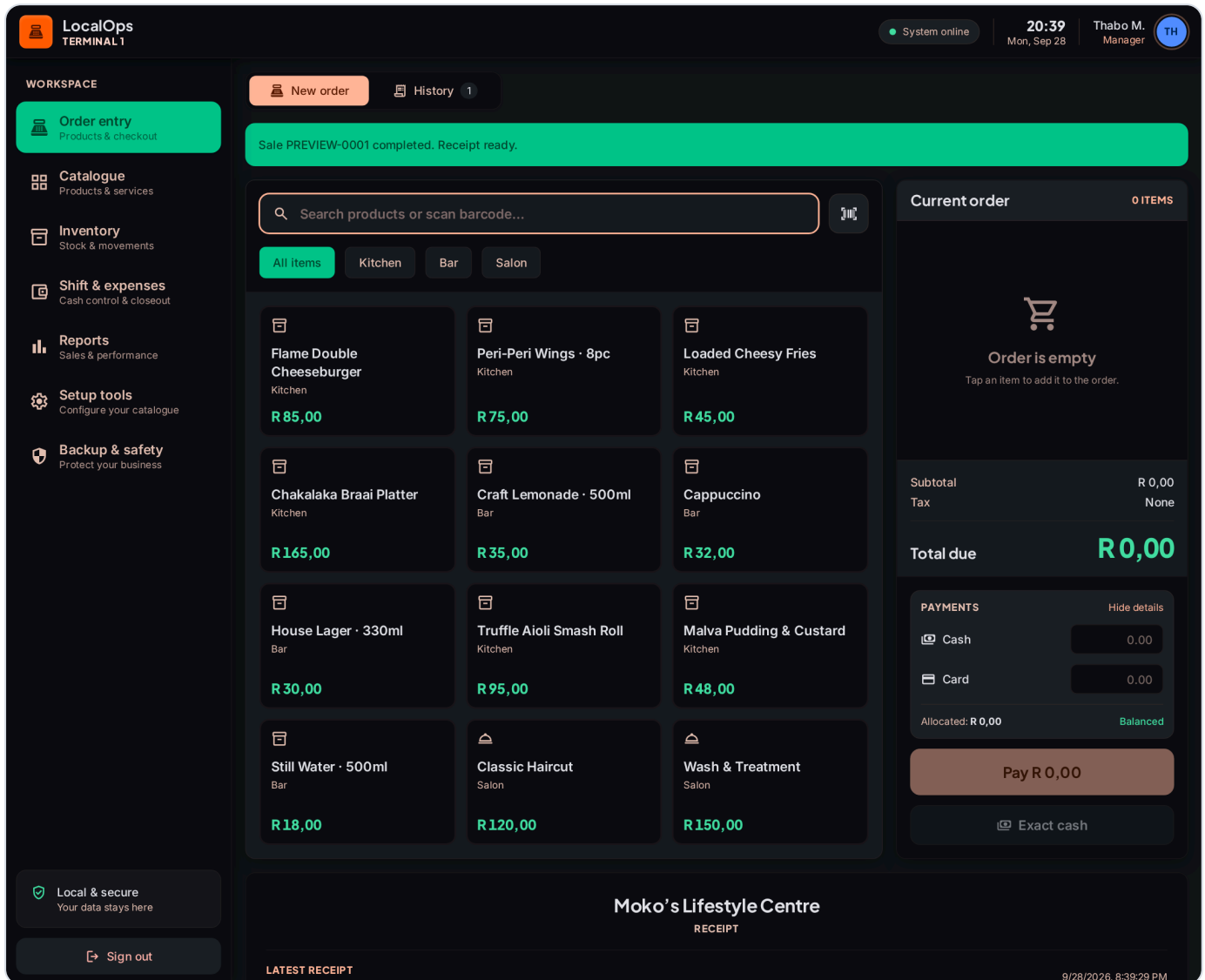
REASON	WHAT TO DO
The order is empty	Add at least one item.
No shift is open	Open the shift (chapter 5).
The amounts do not add up	Look at the Allocated line and fix the numbers.
A box has bad text in it	Use only digits and one full stop, with two decimals: 85.00 .
The sale is busy saving	Wait. Never press twice.

NEVER DO THIS

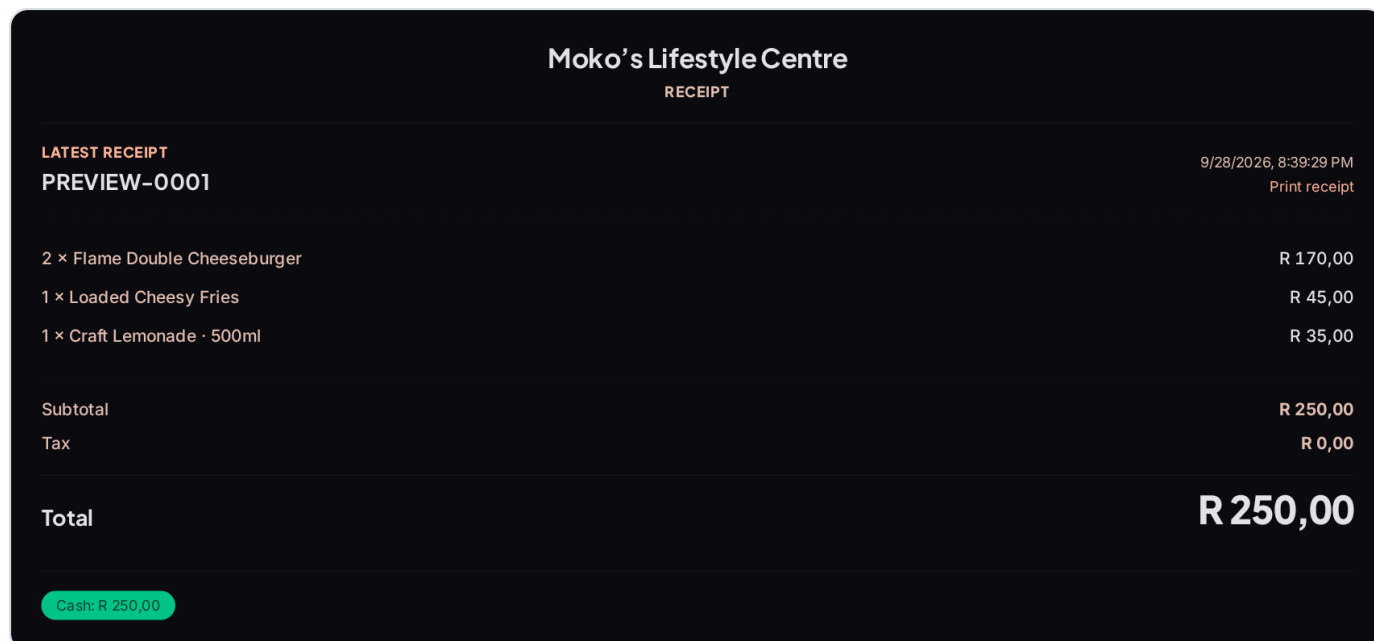
Never type a cash amount that the customer did not give you to make the sale “balance”. The drawer will be short at the end of the shift and the variance will point straight at your shift.

9. The receipt

The moment the sale is saved, a green bar confirms the receipt number and the receipt appears under the till.



Picture 9.1 — Sale completed. The green bar reads “Sale PREVIEW-0001 completed. Receipt ready.” The order panel is empty again and is ready for the next customer.



Picture 9.2 — The latest receipt, close up. Business name, receipt number, date and time, every line, the subtotal, the tax, the total, and a green badge for each payment taken.

- 1 Read the total to the customer and hand over the change.
- 2 Press **Print receipt** at the top right of the receipt.
- 3 Choose the printer in the Windows window that opens, then press Print.

CAREFUL

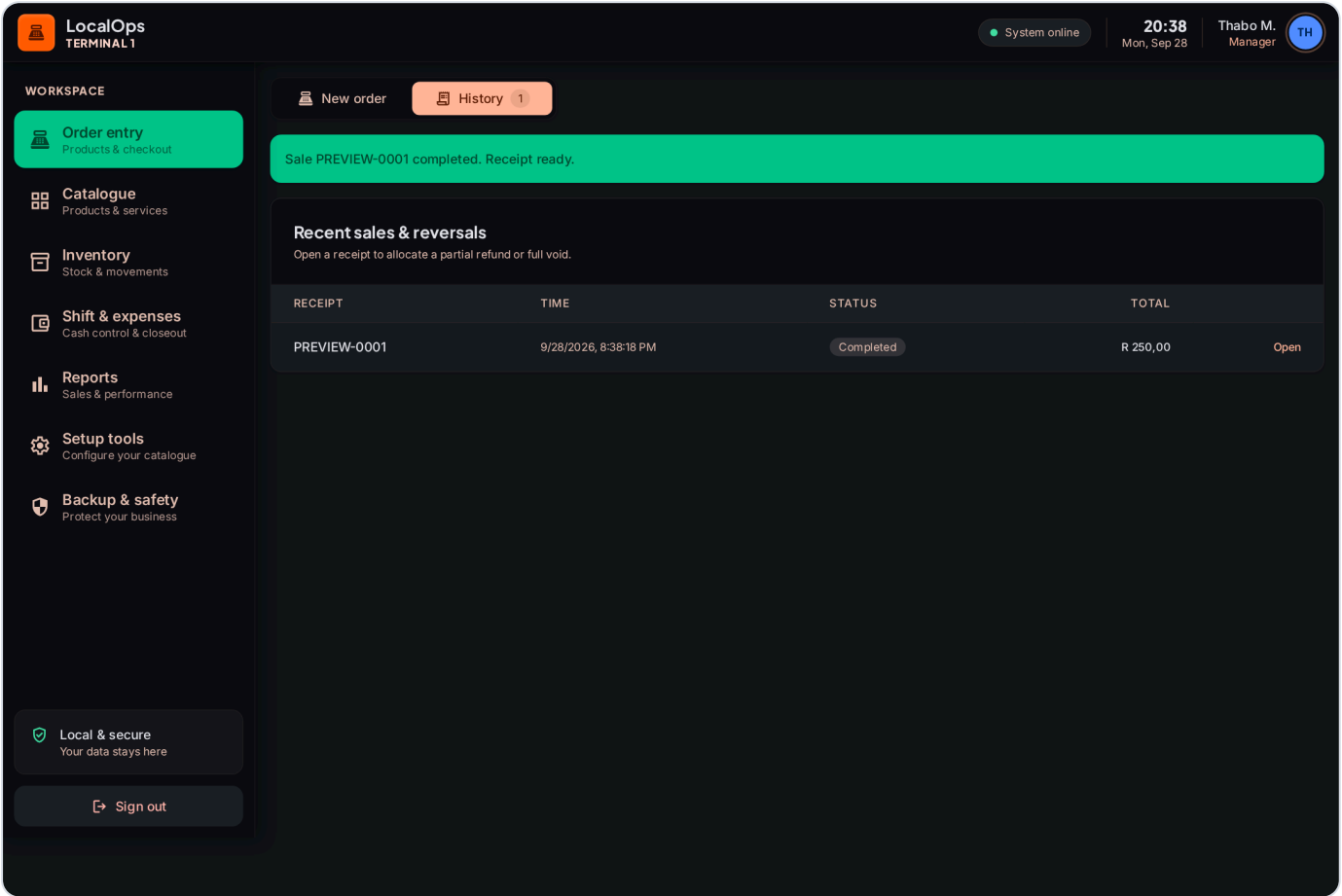
Print the receipt **before** you start the next customer. This version cannot re-print an old receipt from the History tab.

GOOD HABIT

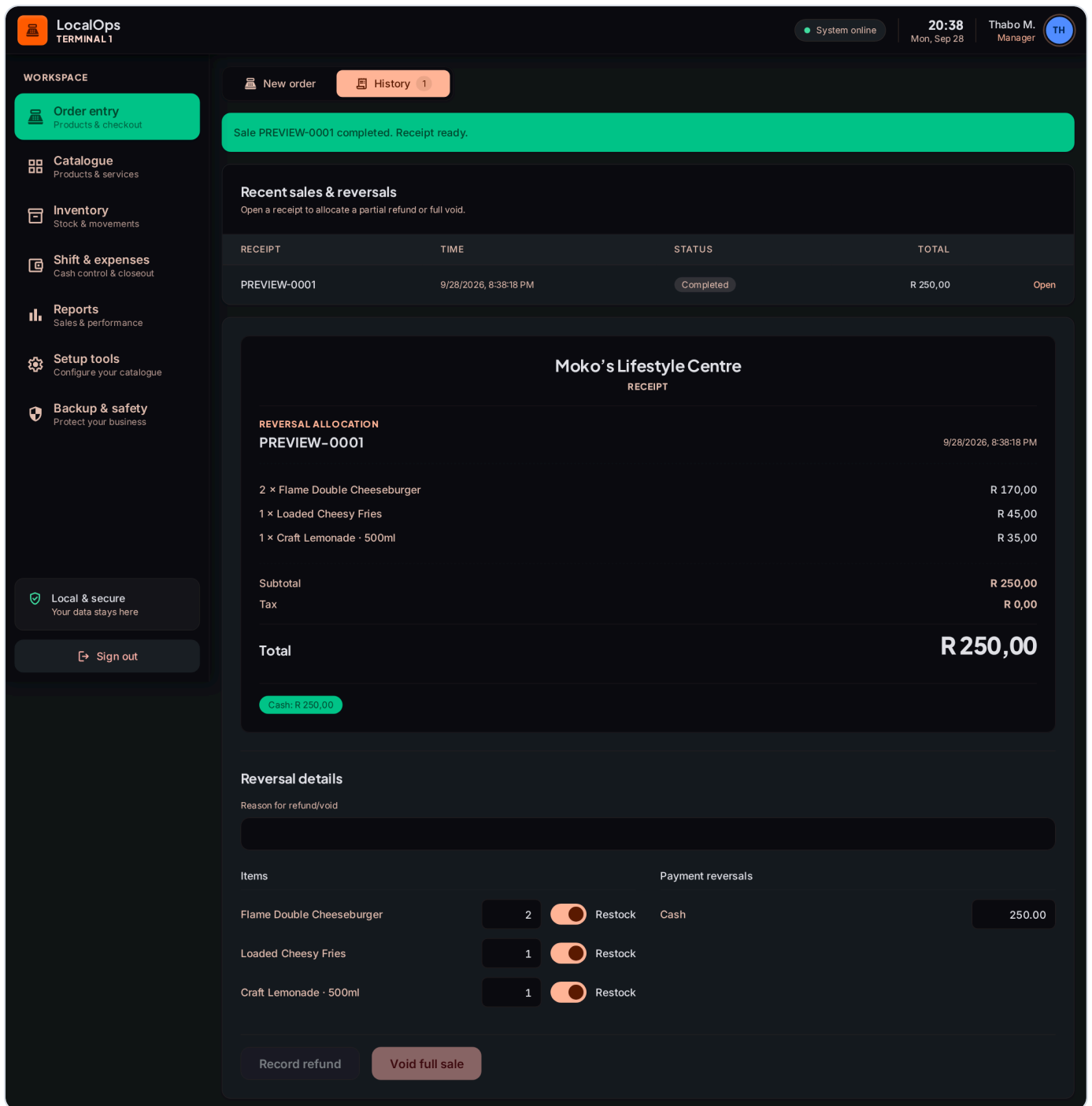
If the printer jams or has no paper, the sale is still safely recorded. Fix the printer, then write the receipt number on a slip for the customer and explain politely.

10. Refunds and voids

Use **History** to give money back. A refund returns part of a sale. A void reverses the whole sale. Neither one deletes anything: the original receipt stays exactly as it was and the reversal is added next to it.



Picture 10.1 — History. Every recent sale with its receipt number, time, status and total. Press **Open** on the right of the line you need.



Picture 10.2 — Reversal allocation. The original receipt is shown at the top so you can check it. Underneath, **Reversal details** lets you choose the reason, the quantities, whether stock comes back, and how much money goes back to each payment method.

10.1 Refunding part of a sale

- 1 Open the **History** tab and press **Open** on the sale.
- 2 Type a clear **Reason for refund/void**, for example *"Wrong item, customer swapped"*. It is compulsory.
- 3 Under **Items**, set the quantity for every line. Put **0** on the lines you are **not** refunding.
- 4 Switch **Restock** on only if the physical item came back and can be sold again. Switch it off for food that was eaten or anything damaged. Services can never be restocked.

- 5 Under **Payment reversals**, type how much goes back to each method. Put **0.00** where nothing goes back. Normally you refund to the same method the customer paid with.
- 6 Press **Record refund**.

10.2 Voiding a whole sale

- 1 Open the sale from **History**.
- 2 Type the reason, for example *"Rung up on wrong till"*.
- 3 Check that every item quantity is the full quantity and that the payment amounts equal the full total.
- 4 Set the **Restock** switches correctly.
- 5 Press **Void full sale**.

IF THE SCREEN REFUSES	THE REASON IS USUALLY
Buttons are grey	No shift is open, or the reason box is empty.
"Permission denied"	Your account may not refund or void. Call a supervisor — do not use their PIN.
"exceeds refundable ..."	You are trying to give back more items or more money than is left on that sale. Check what was already refunded.

NEVER DO THIS

Never refund cash for a card sale and never "fix" a mistake by ringing up a negative-looking sale. Always use the refund or void screen so the trail is honest and complete.

11. First-run setup (new business)

You only ever see this screen once per computer: the very first time LocalOps POS opens with an empty database. A teller will normally never see it.

The screenshot shows the 'Build workspace' screen for LocalOps POS. On the left, there's a logo and text: 'LOCALOPS POS', 'Your business. One place. Always available.', and 'The lightning-fast, offline-first point of sale system designed for modern touchscreen terminals.' On the right, the 'FIRST-RUN SETUP' section has a green 'OFFLINE READY' badge. Below this, the 'Build workspace' title is followed by the instruction: 'Create the business, its first operation, and the owner account in one secure offline step.' The form contains several input fields: 'Business name' (Moko's Lifestyle Centre), 'Terminal name' (Main Till), 'First department' (Bar), 'Main stock location' (Main Store), 'Owner username' (owner), 'Owner PIN' (4-12 digits), and 'Owner display name' (Moko). A large orange 'Create business →' button is at the bottom of the form. Below the form, a 'WHAT HAPPENS NEXT' section lists five steps: 1. Business setup (highlighted), 2. Departments & locations, 3. Products & services, 4. Inventory, and 5. POS & payments. At the very bottom, three status icons are shown: 'Data stays on this device', 'Secure local storage', and 'Automatic local backups'.

FIRST-RUN SETUP • OFFLINE READY

Build workspace

Create the business, its first operation, and the owner account in one secure offline step.

Business name	Terminal name
Moko's Lifestyle Centre	Main Till
First department	Main stock location
Bar	Main Store
Owner username	Owner PIN
owner	4-12 digits
Owner display name	
Moko	

Create business →

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

- 1 Business setup
- 2 Departments & locations
- 3 Products & services
- 4 Inventory
- 5 POS & payments

Data stays on this device Secure local storage Automatic local backups

Picture 11.1 — Build workspace. One form creates the business, its first department, its stock location, this till and the owner account, all together.

BOX	WHAT TO TYPE
Business name	The trading name, for example <i>Moko's Lifestyle Centre</i> .
Terminal name	A name for this computer, for example <i>Main Till</i> .
First department	The first selling area, for example <i>Bar, Kitchen</i> or <i>Salon</i> .
Main stock location	Where stock is kept, for example <i>Main Store</i> .
Owner username	The sign-in name for the owner, for example <code>owner</code> .
Owner PIN	4 to 12 digits. Write it down and lock it away.
Owner display name	The name shown at the top right of the screen, for example <i>Moko</i> .

The panel **What happens next** shows the order of work after setup: business setup → departments and locations → products and services → inventory → POS and payments.

CAREFUL

The owner PIN cannot be read back out of the program later. If it is lost, only your administrator can help.

The order to build a new shop

- 1 Create categories and units in **Setup tools**.
- 2 Create your products and services in **Catalogue**.
- 3 Add packaging (crates, cases) and recipes if you need them.
- 4 Make each item available to a department in **Setup tools** — **items only appear on the till after this step**.
- 5 Add suppliers, then receive your opening stock in **Inventory**.
- 6 Open a shift, do one test sale, print the receipt, then refund it.
- 7 Make a manual backup in **Backup & safety**.

12. Catalogue — products & services

The catalogue is the list of everything the business can sell. The three counters at the top tell you how many active items, products and services exist.

LocalOps
TERMINAL 1

System online

20:38
Mon, Sep 28

Thabo M.
Manager

TH

WORKSPACE

Order entry
Products & checkout

Catalogue
Products & services

Inventory
Stock & movements

Shift & expenses
Cash control & closeout

Reports
Sales & performance

Setup tools
Configure your catalogue

Backup & safety
Protect your business

Local & secure
Your data stays here

Sign out

CATALOGUE

Products & services

12
ACTIVE ITEMS

10
PRODUCTS

2
SERVICES

Add an item

Start with the essentials. Packaging and recipes can be added afterward.

Product

Name

Price (ZAR)

Category

Base unit

Cost (ZAR)

Barcode (optional)

SKU (optional)

Product code (optional)

Track stock

Taxable

Add product

ITEM	TYPE	PRICE	LOCAL LOOKUP	STOCK / DURATION	COMPOSITION
Flame Double Cheeseburger Uncategorised	Product	R 85,00	6001000000000 · SKU-001 · BURGER	Tracked	Standard
Peri-Peri Wings · 8pc Uncategorised	Product	R 75,00	6001000000001 · SKU-002 · WINGS	Tracked	Standard
Loaded Cheesy Fries Uncategorised	Product	R 45,00	6001000000002 · SKU-003 · FRIES	Tracked	Standard
Chakalaka Braai Platter Uncategorised	Product	R 165,00	6001000000003 · SKU-004 · PLATTER	Tracked	Standard
Craft Lemonade · 500ml Uncategorised	Product	R 35,00	6001000000004 · SKU-005 · LEMONADE	Tracked	Standard
Cappuccino Uncategorised	Product	R 32,00	6001000000005 · SKU-006 · COFFEE	Tracked	Standard
House Lager · 330ml Uncategorised	Product	R 30,00	6001000000006 · SKU-007 · LAGER	Tracked	Standard
Truffle Aioli Smash Roll Uncategorised	Product	R 95,00	6001000000007 · SKU-008 · SMASH	Tracked	Standard
Malva Pudding & Custard Uncategorised	Product	R 48,00	6001000000008 · SKU-009 · PUDDING	Tracked	Standard
Still Water · 500ml Uncategorised	Product	R 18,00	6001000000009 · SKU-010 · WATER	Tracked	Standard
Classic Haircut Uncategorised	Service	R 120,00	6001000000010 · SKU-011 · CUT	30 min	Standard
Wash & Treatment Uncategorised	Service	R 150,00	6001000000011 · SKU-012 · TREATMENT	30 min	Standard

Picture 12.1 — Products & services. The **Add an item** form on top, the full item table underneath with price, lookup codes, stock tracking and composition.

LocalOps POS — User manual for tellers and trainers

24

12.1 Adding a product

- 1 Choose **Product** in the small list at the top right of the form.
- 2 **Name** — what the teller will see on the button. Keep it short and clear.
- 3 **Price (ZAR)** — the selling price, for example `25.00`.
- 4 **Category** — optional grouping for reports.
- 5 **Base unit** — how you count it, usually *EA* — *Each*.
- 6 **Cost (ZAR)** — what you pay for one. Used for profit reports.
- 7 **Barcode, SKU, Product code** — optional, but a barcode makes scanning possible. Each value must be unique in the business.
- 8 **Track stock** — leave on for anything physical.
- 9 **Taxable** — set as your business requires.
- 10 Press **Add product**.

12.2 Adding a service

Switch the list to **Service**, then type the name, price, optional category and optional duration in minutes, set **Taxable**, and press **Add service**. A service has no stock of its own, but it can eat stock through a recipe (for example, a treatment that uses 30 ml of product).

12.3 Reading the table

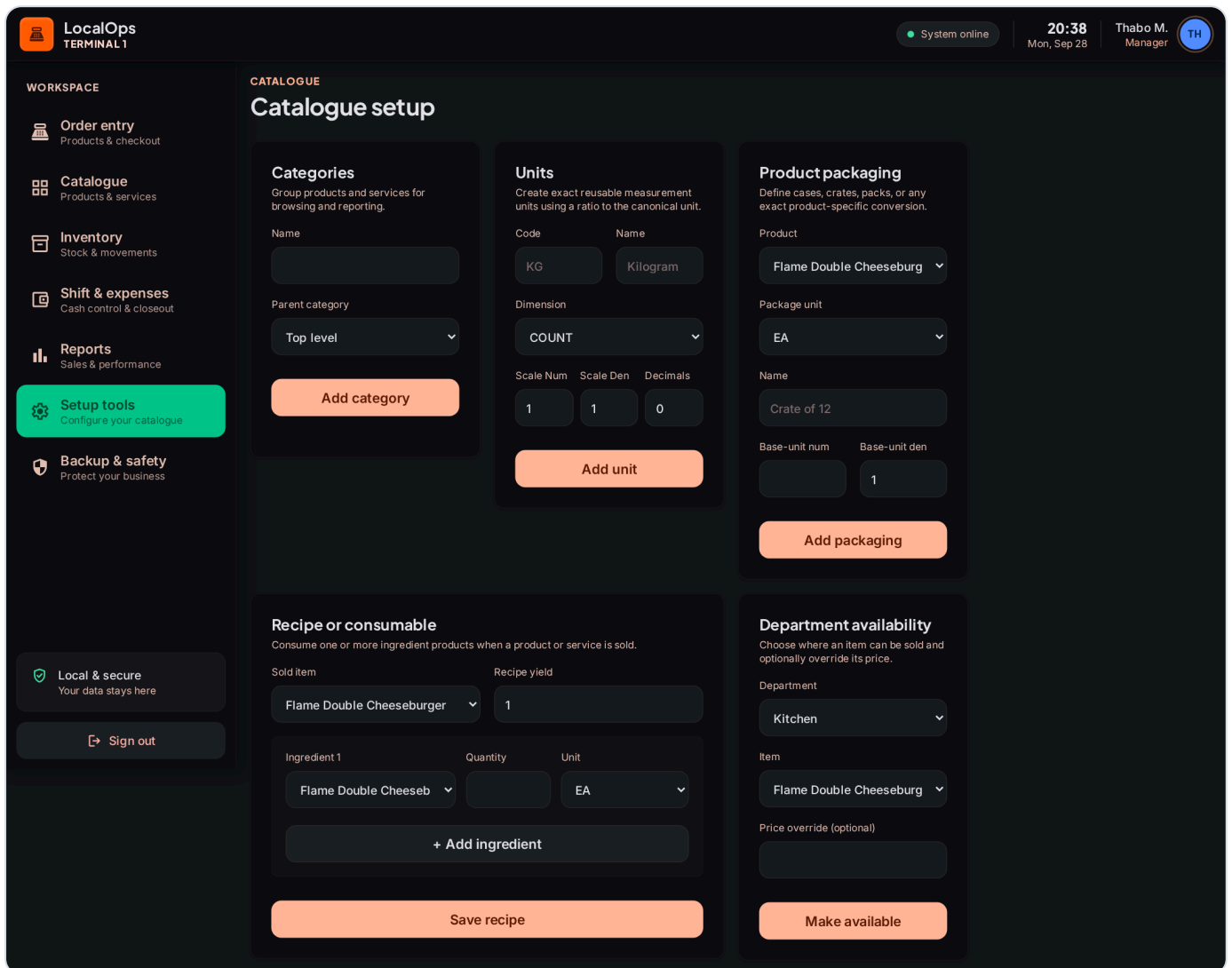
COLUMN	MEANING
Item	Name and category.
Type	Product or Service .
Price	The catalogue price before any department override.
Local lookup	Barcode · SKU · product code — what a scanner or the search bar can match.
Stock / duration	<i>Tracked</i> for stock items, or the service length in minutes.
Composition	<i>Standard</i> , or shows packaging and recipe information when set.

CAREFUL

There is no edit or delete button in this version. Check the spelling and the price before you press Add.

13. Setup tools — categories, units, packaging, recipes

Setup tools is the workshop behind the catalogue. Five small panels, each with one job.



Picture 13.1 — Catalogue setup. Categories, Units and Product packaging on top; Recipe or consumable and Department availability below.

13.1 Categories

Type a **Name**, choose a **Parent category** (or leave it on *Top level*) and press **Add category**. Categories group items for browsing and reports, for example *Drinks* → *Beer*.

13.2 Units

A unit is how you measure an item. Each unit has a **Code** (KG), a **Name** (Kilogram), a **Dimension** (COUNT, WEIGHT, VOLUME, LENGTH or TIME), a scale as a fraction, and how many **Decimals** are allowed.

UNIT	DIMENSION	SCALE NUM	SCALE DEN	DECIMALS
EA — Each	COUNT	1	1	0
G — Gram (the base)	WEIGHT	1	1	3
KG — Kilogram	WEIGHT	1000	1	3

Units that must convert into one another must share the same dimension. The program refuses a conversion that is not mathematically exact.

13.3 Product packaging

Packaging says how a buying unit converts to the selling unit — for example a crate that holds 12 bottles. Choose the **Product**, the **Package unit**, type a clear **Name** (*Crate of 12*), put **12** in **Base-unit num** and **1** in **Base-unit den**, then press **Add packaging**. Receiving 2 crates then adds 24 bottles to stock.

13.4 Recipe or consumable

A recipe takes ingredients out of stock when the item is sold.

- 1 Choose the **Sold item** (a product or a service).
- 2 Set the **Recipe yield** — use **1** when the ingredients make one sold unit.
- 3 Choose **Ingredient 1**, its **Quantity** and its **Unit**.
- 4 Press **+ Add ingredient** for each extra ingredient.
- 5 Press **Save recipe**.

Saving a new recipe replaces the old one from that moment forward. Sales that already happened keep the recipe that was used at the time.

13.5 Department availability

This is the step people forget. An item only appears on the till after you make it available:

- 1 Choose the **Department**.
- 2 Choose the **Item**.
- 3 Optionally type a **Price override** — the price for that department only (happy-hour pricing, for example).
- 4 Press **Make available**.

14. Inventory — stock control

Stock is kept as a ledger: a list of every movement that ever happened. The balance you see is the sum of that list, so it can always be explained.

LocalOps

TERMINAL 1

System online

20:38
Mon, Sep 28

Thabo M.
Manager

TH

WORKSPACE

Order entry

Products & checkout

Catalogue

Products & services

Inventory

Stock & movements

Shift & expenses

Cash control & closeout

Reports

Sales & performance

Setup tools

Configure your catalogue

Backup & safety

Protect your business

Local & secure

Your data stays here

Sign out

INVENTORY

Stock control

Ledger-backed

10

TRACKED PRODUCTS

10

PRODUCT/LOCATION BALANCES

0

RECONCILIATION DIFFERENCES

PRODUCT	LOCATION	ON HAND	CACHE VERSION
Flame Double Cheeseburger	Main Store	24 EA	1
Peri-Peri Wings · 8pc	Main Store	24 EA	1
Loaded Cheesy Fries	Main Store	24 EA	1
Chakalaka Braal Platter	Main Store	24 EA	1
Craft Lemonade · 500ml	Main Store	24 EA	1
Cappuccino	Main Store	24 EA	1
House Lager · 330ml	Main Store	24 EA	1
Truffle Aioli Smash Roll	Main Store	24 EA	1
Malva Pudding & Custard	Main Store	24 EA	1
Still Water · 500ml	Main Store	24 EA	1

Add supplier

Suppliers remain linked to purchase history.

Name

Phone (optional)

Add supplier

Receive purchase

Receiving creates the purchase document, latest cost, ledger movement, and balance in one transaction.

Purchase number

Supplier

No supplier

Receive into

Main Store

Product

Flame Double Cheeseburger (

Purchase unit

EA

Quantity

Unit cost (ZAR)

Invoice reference

Payment status

Unpaid

Receive stock

Transfer stock

Both sides post together with one correlation.

From

Main Str

To

Choose

Product

Flame Double Cheeseburg

Quantity

Complete transfer

Waste or damage

Every loss remains reasoned and auditable.

Location

Main Store

Product

Flame Double Cheeseburg

Quantity

Reason

Physical damage

Record loss

Stock count

Expected stock is preserved before any variance adjustment.

Location

Main Store

Product

Flame Double Cheeseburg

Counted quantity

Complete count

Recent movements

The append-only source of truth for every balance.

TIME	PRODUCT	LOCATION	TYPE	QUANTITY	REFERENCE
------	---------	----------	------	----------	-----------

Picture 14.1 — Stock control. Counters and balances on top; the forms for supplier, receiving, transfer, waste and counting below; the movement history at the bottom.

14.1 The three counters

COUNTER	MEANING
Tracked products	How many products have stock tracking switched on.
Product/location balances	How many product-and -place combinations exist.
Reconciliation differences	Must be 0. Anything else means a balance disagrees with the ledger — tell the owner and call support.

14.2 Add a supplier

Type the **Name**, optionally a **Phone**, and press **Add supplier**. Suppliers stay linked to the purchases you receive from them.

14.3 Receive a purchase

- 1 Type a **Purchase number** that has not been used before (use the supplier invoice number).
- 2 Choose the **Supplier**, or *No supplier*.
- 3 Choose **Receive into** — the place the stock is going.
- 4 Choose the **Product** and the **Purchase unit** (the base unit, or a packaging such as *Crate of 12*).
- 5 Type the **Quantity** and the **Unit cost (ZAR)** for that purchase unit.
- 6 Optionally type an **Invoice reference**, and set **Payment status** to Unpaid, Part paid or Paid.
- 7 Press **Receive stock**.

One press creates the purchase, updates the product's latest cost, writes the stock movement and updates the balance. If anything is wrong, nothing at all is saved.

14.4 Transfer, waste and counting

FORM	HOW TO USE IT
Transfer stock	Choose From and a different To location, the product and the quantity, then Complete transfer . It stays switched off while the business has only one location.
Waste or damage	Choose the location and product, type the quantity lost and a clear Reason , switch on Physical damage if the item was broken, then Record loss .
Stock count	Choose the location and product, type the Counted quantity you physically counted and press Complete count . The system keeps the expected figure and posts only the difference.

14.5 Recent movements

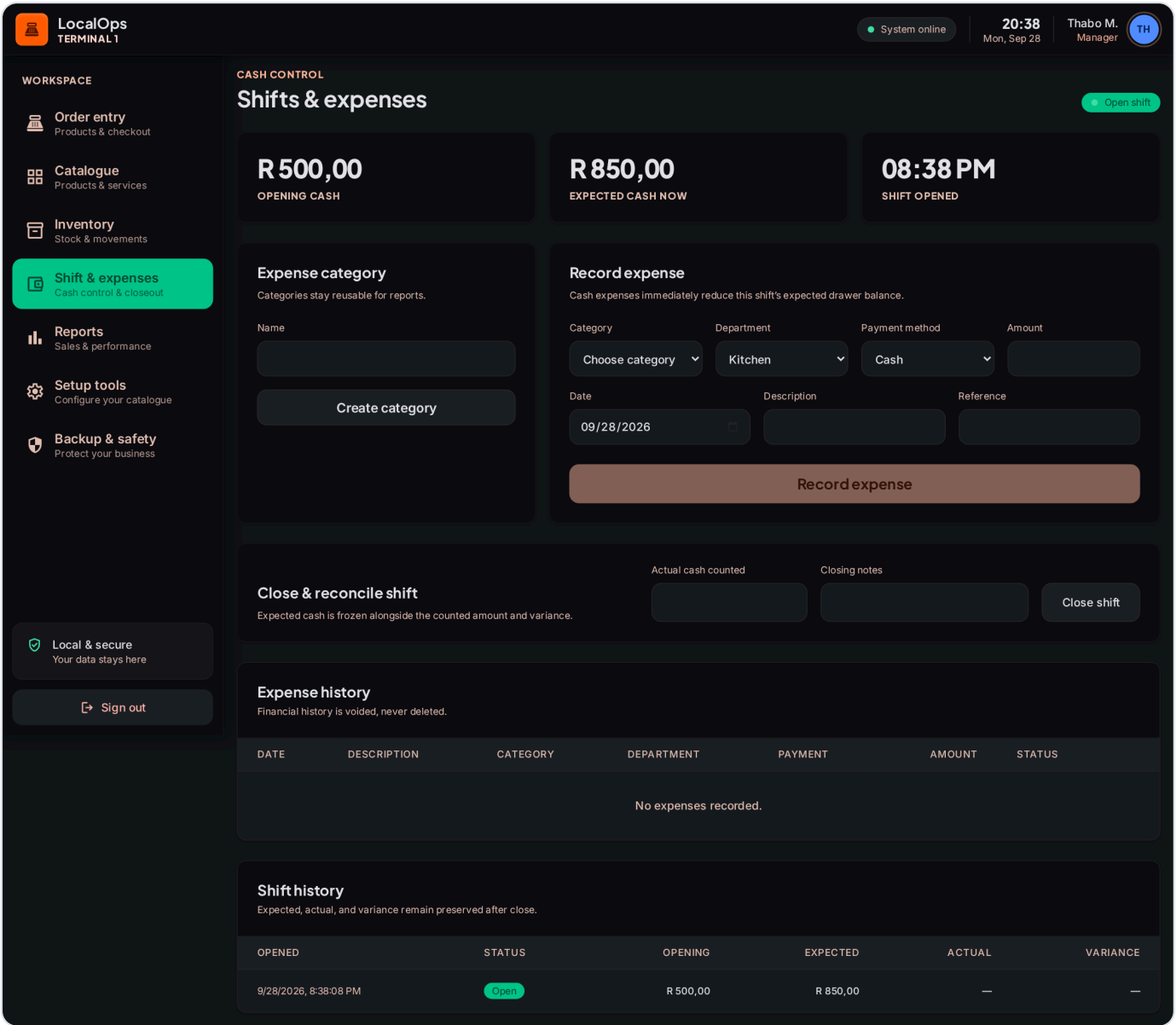
The table at the bottom is the truth behind every balance: time, product, location, movement type, quantity and reference. A positive quantity adds stock; a negative quantity takes it away.

NEVER DO THIS

Never invent a purchase to get past an “insufficient stock” message. Receive the real stock or do an authorised stock count. False receipts destroy the value of every report that follows.

15. Shifts & expenses

This page is where the drawer is opened, where money paid out of the drawer is recorded, and where the shift is counted and closed.



Picture 15.1 — Shifts & expenses. Opening cash, expected cash and the start time on top; expense forms in the middle; close and reconcile, expense history and shift history below.

15.1 The three figures

FIGURE	MEANING
Opening cash	What you counted into the drawer when the shift opened.
Expected cash now	Opening cash + cash sales – cash refunds – cash expenses. This is what should be in the drawer at this moment.
Shift opened	The time the shift started.

15.2 Recording an expense

You need at least one expense category and an open shift first. To create a category, type a name such as *Transport* and press **Create category**.

- 1 Choose the **Category**.
- 2 Choose the **Department**, or business-wide.
- 3 Choose the **Payment method** — pick *Cash* only when money really left the drawer.
- 4 Type the **Amount**.
- 5 Check the **Date**.
- 6 Type a useful **Description** ("*Taxi to collect gas bottle*") and an optional **Reference**.
- 7 Press **Record expense**.

A cash expense lowers **Expected cash now** immediately. Other methods do not touch the drawer.

15.3 Voiding an expense

Find the entry in **Expense history**, press **Void**, type the reason and confirm. The entry stays visible with a *void* status — financial history is voided, never deleted.

15.4 Closing and counting the shift

- 1 Stop serving customers on this till.
- 2 Take the drawer to a safe place and count all the cash.
- 3 Type the true figure in **Actual cash counted**.
- 4 Add **Closing notes** if something needs explaining.
- 5 Press **Close shift**.

The shift history row then keeps the opening, expected, actual and variance figures for ever.

VARIANCE	MEANING	WHAT TO DO
R 0,00	Perfect.	Nothing.
Positive (over)	More cash than expected — change not given, or a sale rung up short.	Write a note and tell your supervisor.
Negative (short)	Less cash than expected — too much change, a missed sale, or an unrecorded payout.	Recount, check expenses, then report it the same day.

GOOD HABIT

Count the drawer without looking at the expected figure first. Then compare. This keeps the count honest.

16. Reports

The business dashboard answers: what did we sell, what did we earn, what did we spend, and what is still on the shelf?

The screenshot shows the LocalOps Business dashboard interface. At the top, it displays 'LocalOps TERMINAL 1', 'System online', the time '20:38', the date 'Mon, Sep 28', and the user 'Thabo M. Manager'. The left sidebar contains navigation options: Workspace (Order entry, Catalogue, Inventory, Shift & expenses), Reports (Sales & performance), Setup tools, and Backup & safety. The main content area is titled 'Business dashboard' and includes a date range selector (From: 09/01/2026, To: 09/28/2026) with 'Refresh' and 'Export CSV' buttons. Below this are six summary cards: NET SALES (R 3 462,00), ESTIMATED GROSS PROFIT (R 1 420,50), EXPENSES (R 324,00), REFUNDS & VOIDS (R 18,50), STOCK VALUE (R 9 650,00), and LOW-STOCK BALANCES (0). The dashboard also features two tables: 'Departments' (showing Gross, Refunds, Net, and Gross Profit for Kitchen, Bar, and Salon) and 'Payments' (showing Method, Received, Refunded, and Net for Cash and Card). A 'Current stock valuation' table is also present, indicating 'No inventory balances yet.' At the bottom, it shows 'GROSS SALES' (R 3 480,50) and 'SHIFT VARIANCE' (R 0,00) for the range 2026-09-01 to 2026-09-28.

Picture 16.1 — Business dashboard. Date range and export at the top, six summary cards, then the Departments, Payments and Current stock valuation tables, with gross sales and shift variance at the bottom.

16.1 Choosing the period

Set **From** and **To**, then press **Refresh**. The dashboard opens on the first day of this month up to today. The badge at the bottom right always repeats the range you are looking at.

16.2 What the cards mean

CARD	MEANING
Net sales	Sales after refunds and voids.
Estimated gross profit	Sales less the recorded cost of the items sold. It is an estimate for management, not a financial statement.
Expenses	Operating expenses recorded in the period.
Refunds & voids	Money given back in the period.
Stock value	What is on the shelf right now, valued at the latest cost.
Low - stock balances	How many product balances are at or under their minimum.
Gross sales (bottom)	Sales before refunds.
Shift variance (bottom)	All shift variances in the period added together.

16.3 The tables

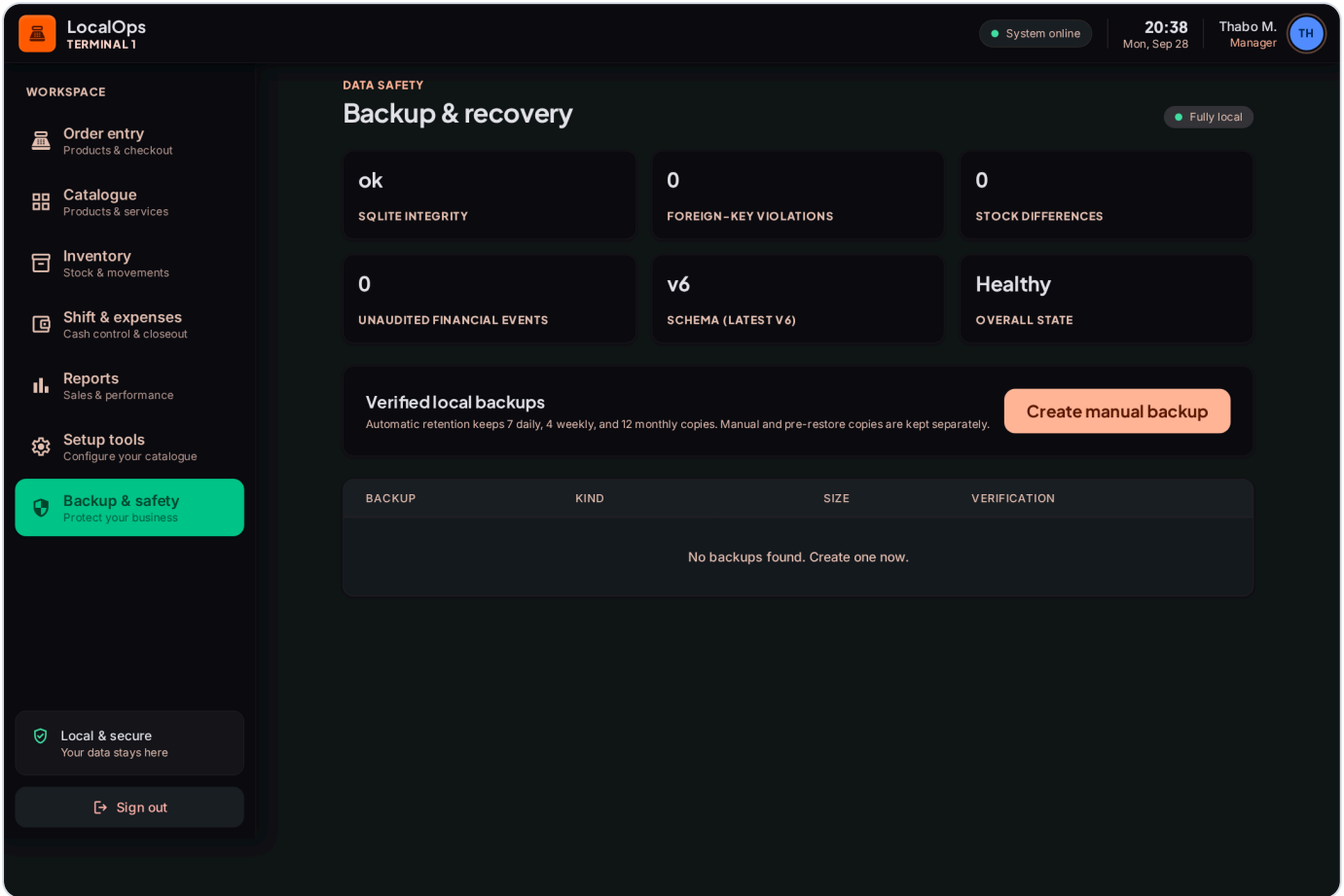
- **Departments** — gross, refunds, net and estimated gross profit per department.
- **Payments** — received, refunded and net per payment method. Compare the Cash net figure with your drawer counts.
- **Current stock valuation** — on hand, minimum and value per product and location.

16.4 Export CSV

Choose the range, press **Export CSV** and save the file. It is named `localops-report-YYYY-MM-DD-to-YYYY-MM-DD.csv` and opens in any spreadsheet program. Treat the file as confidential business information.

17. Backup & safety

There is no cloud copy. This page is the only thing standing between the business and a lost hard drive.



Picture 17.1 — Backup & recovery. Six health cards on top, then the backup list with the **Create manual backup** button.

17.1 Reading the health cards

CARD	HEALTHY VALUE
SQLite integrity	ok
Foreign-key violations	0
Stock differences	0
Unaudited financial events	0
Schema	Current version equals the latest version, e.g. v6 (latest v6)
Overall state	Healthy

NEVER DO THIS

Never ignore a card that is not healthy, and never “try things” to fix it. Write the exact values down, make a backup if the button still works, stop non-essential work and call support.

17.2 Making a backup

- 1 Open **Backup & safety**.
- 2 Check that the overall state is **Healthy**.
- 3 Press **Create manual backup**.
- 4 Wait for the green “*Verified backup created*” message.
- 5 Check that the new row in the table says **Verified**.

The program also keeps automatic copies by itself: 7 daily, 4 weekly and 12 monthly. Manual and pre-restore copies are kept separately from those.

17.3 Restoring a backup

CAREFUL

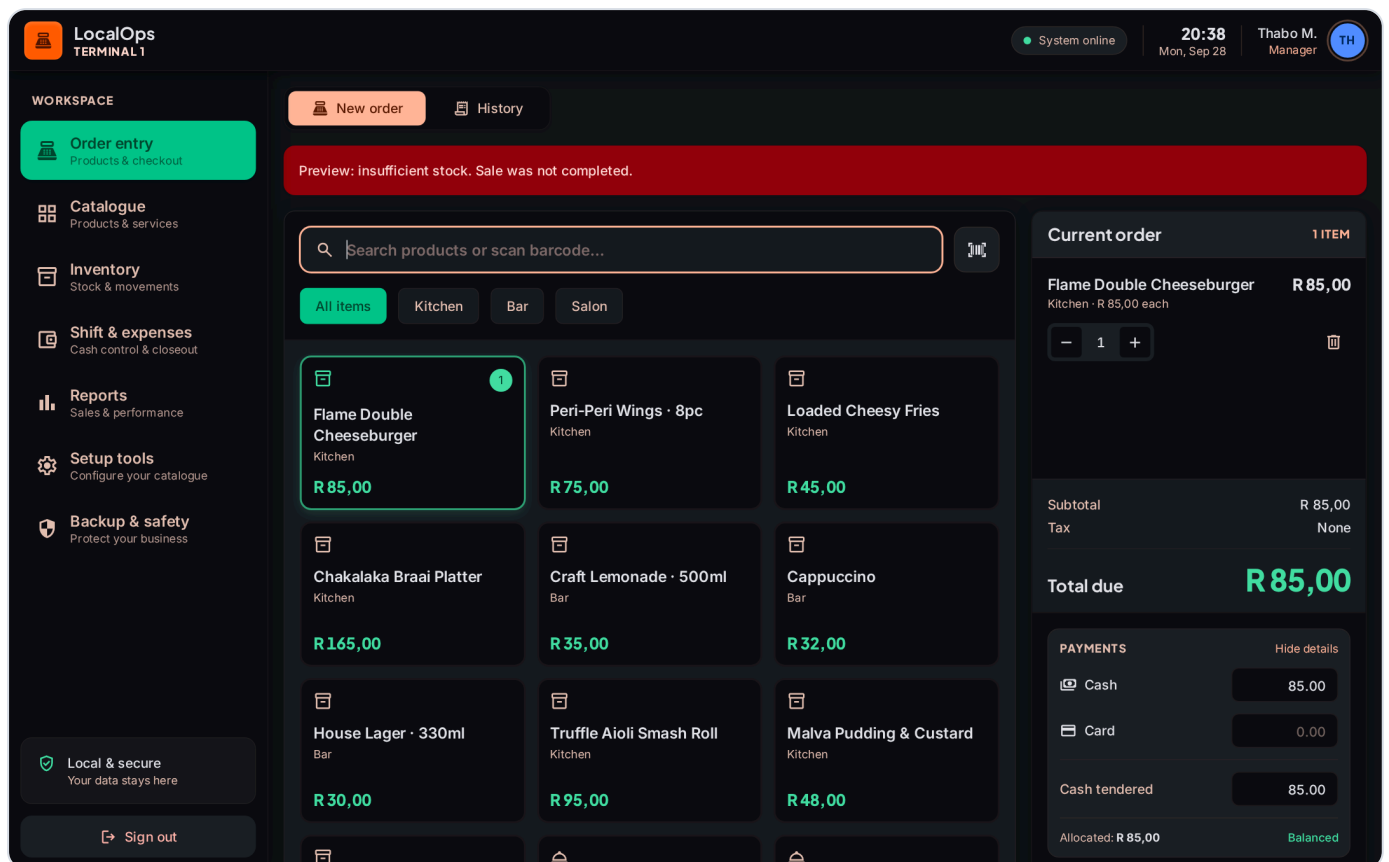
Restoring replaces the current data with the data from the backup. Everything recorded after that backup is not in the restored copy. Only do this with the owner's instruction.

- 1 Stop all selling on the computer.
- 2 Find the verified backup you need in the list.
- 3 Press **Restore** and read the confirmation carefully before approving.
- 4 The program makes a pre-restore safety copy first, then restores, signs you out and reloads.
- 5 Sign in with the credentials that existed at the time of that backup.

17.4 Data rules for everybody

1. Do not put the database on a shared network drive.
2. Do not open `business.db` with any other program.
3. Do not delete the `-wal` or `-shm` files while LocalOps is running.
4. Close LocalOps before an administrator copies backups to external storage.
5. Do not switch the computer off during a sale, a restore or an upgrade.
6. Treat exported CSV files and backup copies as confidential.

18. When something goes wrong

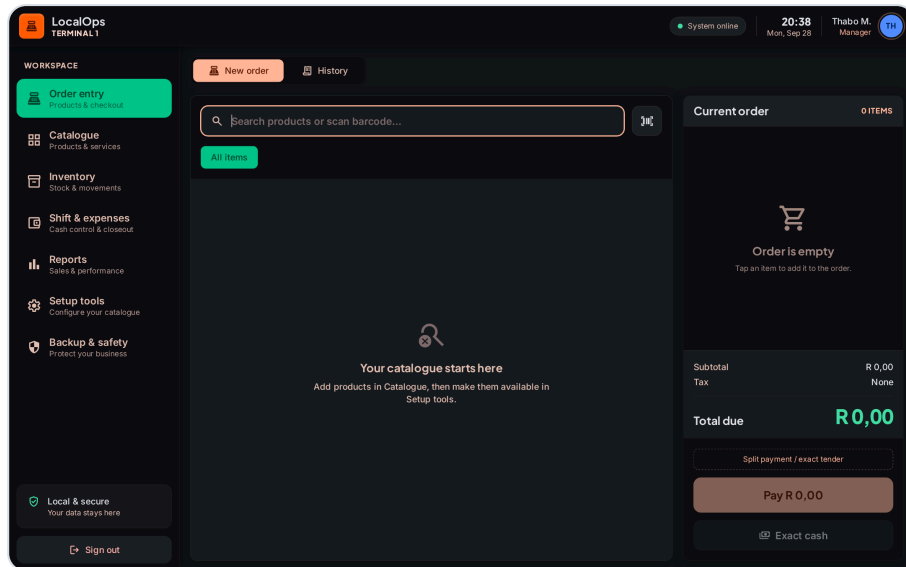


Picture 18.1 — A red message. The sale was **not** saved. The order is still on the right, so nothing is lost: fix the cause and press Pay again.

18.1 Messages you may see

MESSAGE	WHAT TO DO
No local item matches "..."	The code is not on any item, or the item is not available to a department. Tap the item button instead and tell the manager.
Insufficient stock...	The ledger says there is not enough. Check the product and location, receive stock or do an authorised count, then retry.
Permission denied: ...	Your account may not do that action. Ask an authorised person to do it. Never borrow a PIN.
Session missing or expired	Sign in again. Sales that were already completed are safe.
Enter a number with no more than 2 decimal places	Type money as <code>85.00</code> — digits, one full stop, two decimals.
Shift closed badge is red	Open the shift before selling.

18.2 Nothing appears on the till



Picture 18.2 — “Your catalogue starts here”. The till has no items to sell.

This means either nothing has been created in **Catalogue**, or nothing has been made available to a department in **Setup tools**. Both steps are needed. It is almost always the second one.

18.3 Other common problems

PROBLEM	FIRST THINGS TO CHECK
I cannot sign in	Right business and terminal? Username spelled correctly? PIN 4–12 digits? Locked out for five minutes?
The scanner does nothing	Is the cursor in the search bar? Press the barcode icon. Does the scanner send Enter? Test by typing the number and pressing Enter.
The Pay button stays grey	See section 8.4.
The receipt will not print	Check paper, power, cable and the Windows printer. The sale is already saved either way.
Transfer stock is switched off	The business has only one stock location. An administrator must add a second one.
I cannot record an expense	Open a shift and create at least one expense category.
Report figures look wrong	Check the From/To dates, then look at refunds, voids, expenses and shift variance separately.

18.4 What to tell support

- the program version (0.1.0) and the Windows version;
- the business and terminal you were on;

- who was signed in — **never** the PIN;
- the exact red message, word for word;
- what you were doing when it happened, and the time;
- the receipt, purchase or reference number involved; and
- the values on the **Backup & safety** cards, if you can open that page.

19. Trainer's guide

A new teller can be trained on LocalOps POS in about 45 minutes, plus practice. Train on a real till, out of trading hours, and refund or void every practice sale afterwards.

19.1 Lesson plan (45 minutes)

TIME	TOPIC	DO THIS
0–5 min	The four rules	Chapter 2. Explain that nothing is deleted and that everything is recorded under their name.
5–10 min	Sign in, sign out	Let them sign in themselves. Make them sign out and in again twice.
10–15 min	Screen tour	Point at the top strip, the menu and the order panel. Ask them to point back.
15–20 min	Open the till	Count a real float together and open a shift.
20–32 min	Sales	Exercises 1 to 4 below.
32–38 min	Refunds	Exercise 5. Explain Restock properly.
38–45 min	Close the shift	Count, close, look at the variance together.

19.2 Practice exercises

- 1 Simple cash sale.** Two of one item, one of another. Exact cash. Print the receipt.
- 2 Change.** Total R 85,00, customer gives R 100,00. Enter the tender correctly and hand over the change.
- 3 Card sale.** One item on card. Show that cash must stay on 0.00.
- 4 Split payment.** R 250,00 as R 200,00 card and R 50,00 cash, with R 100,00 tendered.
- 5 Refund one line.** Refund only one item from exercise 1, with a written reason, Restock on.
- 6 Mistake drill.** Add a wrong item on purpose, then remove it with the bin icon before paying.

19.3 Sign-off checklist

The trainee is ready for the floor alone when they can do all of this without help:

Basics

- ☐ Signs in with their own PIN and signs out when leaving
- ☐ Names the till they are on from the top strip
- ☐ Counts and opens the shift correctly
- ☐ Finds an item by tapping, by searching and by scanning

Money

- ☐ Fixes a quantity and removes a line
- ☐ Takes cash with change, card, and a split payment
- ☐ Explains why the Pay button is grey
- ☐ Prints the receipt at the right moment

Corrections

- ☐ Finds a sale in History
- ☐ Records a partial refund with a reason
- ☐ Decides correctly whether Restock is on or off
- ☐ Knows when to call a supervisor instead

End of shift

- ☐ Records a cash expense properly
- ☐ Counts the drawer before looking at the expected figure
- ☐ Closes the shift and explains the variance
- ☐ Reports a shortage the same day

Trainee name: _____ Trainer: _____ Date: _____

20. Daily checklists

Opening

- ☐ Start LocalOps POS
- ☐ Check the business and terminal
- ☐ Sign in with your own account
- ☐ Check there are no red warnings
- ☐ Count the opening cash
- ☐ Open the shift with the true amount
- ☐ Check that your items appear on the till
- ☐ Test the receipt printer

Every sale

- ☐ Shift is open
- ☐ Add or scan the right items
- ☐ Check the quantities and the total
- ☐ Allocate the exact payment
- ☐ Enter the real cash tendered
- ☐ Confirm **Balanced**
- ☐ Press Pay once
- ☐ Give the change and print the receipt

Closing

- ☐ Finish or reverse open transactions
- ☐ Record every expense paid from the drawer
- ☐ Check the expense history
- ☐ Count the drawer
- ☐ Close the shift and read the variance
- ☐ Write a note for any difference
- ☐ Make a manual backup (per policy)
- ☐ Sign out

Weekly (manager)

- ☐ Review reports for the week
- ☐ Check refunds and voids for patterns
- ☐ Check reconciliation differences = 0
- ☐ Review low-stock balances
- ☐ Do a stock count on fast movers
- ☐ Check backup health and verified copies
- ☐ Have a verified backup copied off-site

21. Quick reference card

Start of shift

1. Sign in with your own PIN.
2. Count the drawer.
3. Order entry → type the amount → **Open shift**.

Sell

1. Tap or scan the items.
2. Check the quantities and **Total due**.
3. **Exact cash**, or type the amounts per method.
4. Fix **Cash tendered** to what the customer gave.
5. Wait for **Balanced** → press **Pay R ...** once.
6. Give change → **Print receipt**.

Refund

1. **History** → **Open** the sale.
2. Type the reason.
3. Quantities: 0 on lines you keep.
4. Restock on only if the goods came back.
5. Allocate the money back → **Record refund**.

End of shift

1. Record cash expenses.
2. Count the drawer (do not peek at expected).
3. Shift & expenses → **Actual cash counted**.
4. **Close shift** → read the variance → report it.
5. **Sign out**.

REMEMBER

Money in boxes must equal Total due. · Print the receipt straight away. · Never share your PIN. · Report a shortage the same day.

NEED HELP?

CONTACT

Supervisor on duty

Store manager / owner

LocalOps support

LocalOps POS user manual, edition 1.0. The screenshots in this manual were taken from LocalOps POS version 0.1.0 using a demonstration data set (Moko's Lifestyle Centre). Your own screens will show your business name, your departments and your items.